

Pre-Settlement to Moving Day Checklist — New South Wales

The 30-90 day logistics, so nothing falls through the cracks.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal or financial advice.

Section 1 — Immediately After Exchange

- ☐ [] **Confirm building insurance timing with your solicitor.** Risk generally passes to the buyer at exchange in NSW under standard contract terms, but confirm this explicitly and arrange cover promptly rather than assuming settlement day is the trigger.
- ☐ [] **Send your signed contract to your lender/broker immediately** so formal loan documents can be prepared.
- ☐ [] **Diarise your cooling-off deadline** if it applies (5 business days for private treaty sales).
- ☐ [] **Engage your solicitor/conveyancer formally** so they can proceed with searches, requisitions, and liaison with the vendor's side.

Section 2 — 4-6 Weeks Before Settlement

- ☐ [] **Finalise unconditional loan approval** and satisfy all outstanding lender conditions.
- ☐ [] **Get at least 3 removalist quotes** — book early, especially over summer and end-of-month periods when demand peaks.
- ☐ [] **Start decluttering and sourcing packing materials.**
- ☐ [] **Notify your current landlord/agent (if renting)** of your move-out date, respecting your required notice period.

Section 3 — 1-2 Weeks Before Settlement

- ☐ [] **Organise utility connections for the new property** — electricity, gas, water, internet/NBN (prioritise NBN given longer typical connection lead times).
- ☐ [] **Arrange disconnection at your current address** for the day after you vacate.
- ☐ [] **Redirect your mail** via Australia Post (available for up to 12 months).
- ☐ [] **Update your address** with: the electoral roll, your bank(s), employer, Medicare, insurer(s), and Service NSW (driver's licence and vehicle registration).
- ☐ [] **Confirm final settlement figures** with your solicitor/lender, including rates and any strata levy adjustments.
- ☐ [] **Confirm who's lodging your FHOG/FHBAS paperwork**, if applicable, and that it's genuinely underway.

Section 4 — Settlement Week

- ☐ [] **Book your pre-settlement inspection** in the days before settlement to confirm the property matches the agreed condition and inclusions.
- ☐ [] **Confirm final funds transfer arrangements** with your solicitor and lender.
- ☐ [] **Confirm key collection arrangements** — where and when you'll receive keys once settlement is confirmed complete.
- ☐ [] **Confirm your removalist booking for the day after settlement** (or settlement day itself if timing allows) — don't schedule movers before settlement is legally confirmed.

Section 5 — Moving Day and Just After

- ☐ [] **Do a final walkthrough before unpacking**, photographing anything that wasn't present at your pre-settlement inspection.
- ☐ [] **Locate your fuse box, water mains shut-off, and gas shut-off** early.
- ☐ [] **Set up home and contents insurance** if not already arranged — don't rely on the vendor's cover, which typically ends at settlement.
- ☐ [] **Register relevant council services** (bin collection, etc.) if not automatically transferred.
- ☐ [] **Keep all settlement paperwork** (contract, s10.7 certificate, loan documents, FHOG/FHBAS confirmation) together — you'll need these for tax, insurance, and future reference.

Quick Reference — Settlement Week Timeline

TIMING	KEY TASK
Exchange of contracts	Confirm insurance timing, engage solicitor
4-6 weeks out	Loan approval finalised, book removalist
1-2 weeks out	Utilities connected, mail redirected, address updates
Settlement week	Pre-settlement inspection, confirm funds transfer
Settlement day	Keys released, final walkthrough

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